INCH-POUND

A-A-20136B
December 31, 1996
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20136A
May 2, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

MEAT HASH, CANNED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers canned meat hash, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The canned meat hash shall conform to the types in the following list which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Corned Beef
Type II - Roast Beef

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8940

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Preparation and labeling requirements: The canned meat hash shall be prepared in accordance with good commercial practice and shall conform to provisions of 319.302 and 319.303, Meat and Poultry Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA), except Type II, Roast Beef shall not include cured beef or curing agents and shall be labeled as "roast beef hash".

3.2 Composition: Beef shall be the only meat ingredient.

3.3 Finished product:

3.3.1 Appearance and color: The canned meat hash shall have a normal appearance and color for the Type of hash specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

3.3.2 Odor and flavor: The odor and flavor shall be characteristic of canned meat hash specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, rancid, or moldy.

3.3.3 Defects: The meat and potatoes shall appear as distinct particles with uniform distribution. The potatoes and onions shall be practically free from skins, eyes, stems, and dark sections. No more than a slight amount of free liquid shall be present in the product. The canned meat hash shall not contain bone measuring 0.3 inch (0.762 cm) or more in any dimension, nor cartilage measuring 0.5 inch (1.27 cm) or more in any dimension.

3.3.4 Foreign material: Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g.; glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, or metal) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from evidence of rodent or insect infestation.

3.3.5 Net weight: Every lot must meet declared label weight.

3.4 Age requirement: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the canned meat hash shall be manufactured not more than 90 days prior to delivery.

3.5 Thermoprocessing: The filled and sealed containers of canned meat hash shall be thermoprocessed to ensure commercial sterility in accordance with good commercial practice.

3.6 Analytical requirements: Unless otherwise specified, analytical requirements for the canned meat hash shall be as follows:

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Fat content: The average fat content of the finished meat hash shall not exceed 15.0 percent and the fat percentage of meat hash in any individual container shall not exceed 17.0 percent.

Salt content: The average salt content shall not exceed 2.5 percent and the salt percentage of the meat hash in any individual container shall not exceed 2.8 percent.

Moisture content: The average moisture content of the finished meat hash shall not exceed 72.0 percent and the moisture percentage of meat hash in any individual container shall not exceed 81.0 percent.

3.6.1 **Analytical procedure:** Three containers shall be selected at random from each lot.

3.6.2 **Preparation of sample:** The sample shall be prepared according to the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International, Method 983.18(b). The sample to be analyzed shall be a composite of the three containers.

3.6.3 **Analytical testing:** The sample shall be analyzed using the following methods:

Test	Method
Fat	960.39, 976.21, or 985.15
Salt	935.47
Moisture	985.14, 950.46

3.6.4 **Test results:** The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the finished product requirements, as indicated by USDA test results, shall be cause for rejection the lot.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in compliance with all applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The delivered canned meat hash shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the canned meat hash within the commercial marketplace. Delivered canned meat hash shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The canned meat hash provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same canned meat hash offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The canned meat hash shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in this CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

5.3 End item inspection. The end item lot size, expressed as number of cans, shall be declared to the AMS agent by the contractor. Canned meat hash from open cans used for product examination shall remain the property of the contractor.

5.4 Product examination. The canned meat hash shall be examined for the defects listed in Table I. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed can. Cans selected for examination must be free from damage.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Net weight less than labeled on the container.
102	Product does not exhibit distinct beef and potato pieces with uniform distribution.
103	Product has more than a slight amount of free liquid.
104	Potatoes and onions not practically free from skins, eyes, stems, or dark sections.
105	Presence of bone measuring 0.3 inch (0.762 cm) or more in any dimension.
106	Presence of cartilage measuring 0.5 inch (1.27 cm) or more in any dimension.

1/ The canned meat hash shall be examined at a temperature of 70 to 80°F (21.1 to 26.6°C).

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6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- The Type of meat hash required.

7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Source of information for nongovernmental document is as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

7.2.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations are contained in 9 CFR Parts 200 to end. The Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act is contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 0250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation Printing Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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